The Forester Ad Strategy 🌲

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Made For...

Personal Brands, Companies, And Anyone with High Quality Social Media Content That Wants To Post and Maximize Reach On Multiple Social Media Channels, Including Facebook, Instagram, Twitter, LinkedIn and Youtube.

This works great for any company with good content, and all different funnels types. I've mainly used it for mini webinar application funnels and some product funnels for scaled advertising results.

How It Works...

The intention of The Forester ad strategy is to get future buyers of products who don't know you yet (cold audience) into an audience of people aware of your brand for less than $.01 (warm audience). We then are going to convert that newly created warm audience and run direct response ads, and more content towards that person to keep CPMs down and to get a high volume of excited buyers.

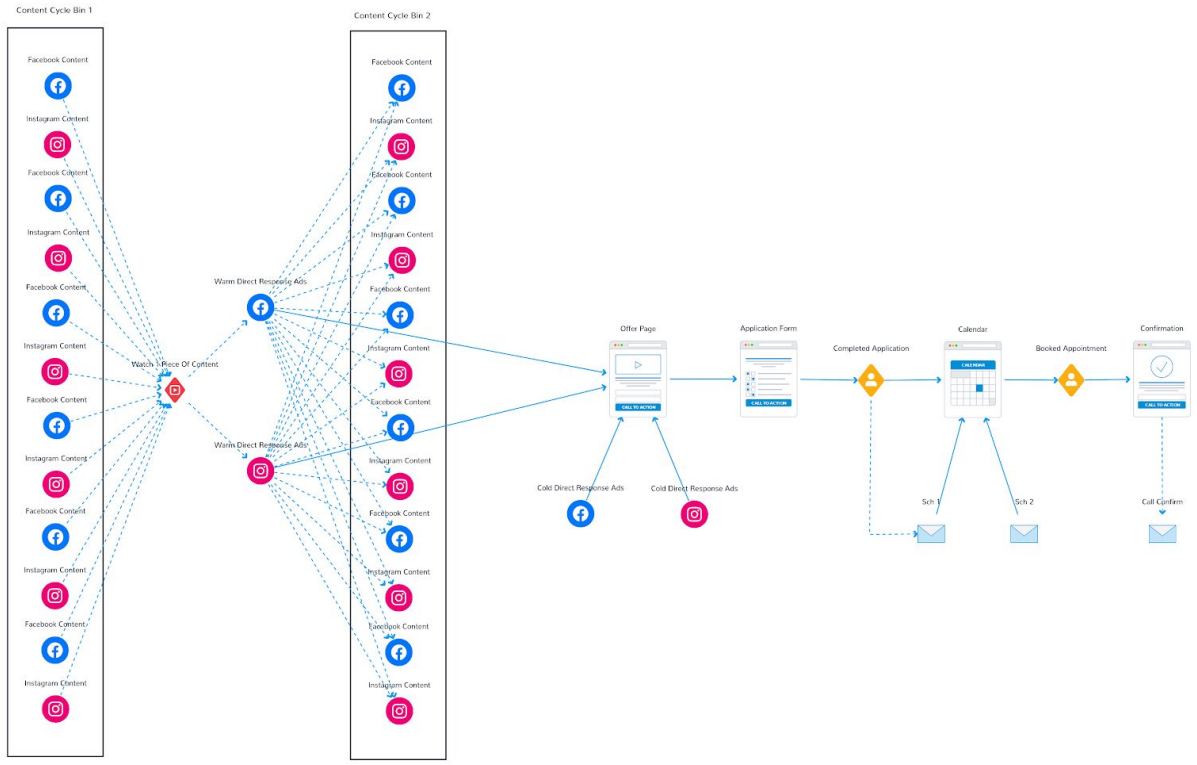
You’re taking a cold audience, and putting content in front of them, with no pitches or call to actions, with engagement campaigns and video view objectives in the Facebook ads manager, and then leveraging the Facebook audience tool to capture video viewers and those interacted with your Facebook and Instagram pages and posts (warm audience).

This strategy is effective because FB tracks the interaction users have with your brand that you’re targeting to factor lower CPM costs or to favor you in auctions against other advertisers bidding to get in front of the same audience.

This strategy is different from the Venus Fly Trap ad strategy I’ve created because rather than running the targeted audience through a sequence of content before seeing the direct response ads, the goal here in the Forester is to simply get a warm audience created from people watching 10 seconds of 1 video we’ll put in front of them out of 5-12 total videos that FB could have served up to them - THEN we hit them with direct response. The main reasoning for doing this is CPMs (cost per 1,000 impressions) is lower with previously engaged traffic in comparison to ice cold traffic that hasn’t previously engaged with your brand.

Here’s a visual of the process:

Megalodon Marketing
a Digital Agency



Why It Works…

We're lowering the costs of CPMs to target cold traffic with our direct response ads, and building a retargeting list at the same time that can be leveraged for up to 1 year from the time the person being targeted last interacted with the brands social media assets (video or profile or post).

This enables us to get higher buyer volumes for less cost from gaming the CPM cost system based on FB putting algorithmic weight on past interaction with someone targeting an audience.

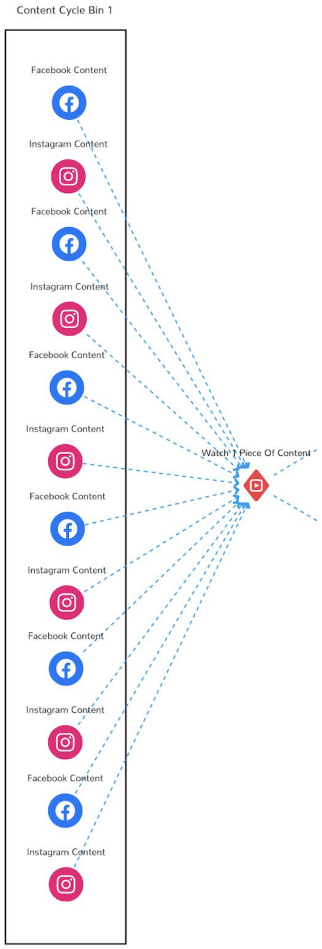
We're also going to warm them up and further frame the user as they are seeing direct response with more content in 'content cycle bin 2'.

This second content cycle bin allows FB to confidently serve up to 5-12 different pieces of content to a user, based on what the user is most probable to engage with.

This also helps the direct response perform better due to showing the targeted audience content that can establish biases like authority, social proof, and credibility. It also helps frame the user with key info or belief management or future objection handling that can supplement the direct response ads success.

This is very effective strategy that time and time again lowers CPM costs, which therefore lowers the cost of the main campaign KPI (cost per purchase, lead, call, etc).

Now, let's move into the technicals of how to set this up so you can execute on it.
The Process…



Let's start with this first step.

We call this 'Cycle Bin 1' - and the intention is simple. We want to take up to 5-12 different pieces of content that capture attention well, frame the brand the right way, and get people interested into a campaign,

The campaign is going to be set up optimized for engagement, and will have 5-12 different ad sets within it optimized for ad set budget optimization.

Each ad set will contain the same cold audience targeting that you want to turn into customers. I like to use a lookalike stack of past customers, past qualified leads, and all qualified people on the email list. If unavailable I'll use cold targeting options that fit the ideal buyer profile.

I like to spend anywhere from $5/day to however much the client will allow me to spend on these because of the effectiveness of this particular step.

The costs will be very low, I average $.01 to sometimes as low as $.0001 (1/100th of a penny) cost per engagement.

Each ad set contains 1 of the 5-12 videos.

1 video per ad set.

I also typically duplicate this campaign after it's finished and will only change what's it's optimized for from engagement to video views optimized for thruplay.

Our goal is to simply get them to watch the video to at least 10 seconds so we can capture that audience and then hit them with direct response ads.

Ad Set Name	Delivery	Bid Strategy	Budget	Last Significant Edit	Results	Reach	Impressions	Cost per Result	Amount Spent
Cold Audiences - Lookalike Audiences All - To...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$30.00 Daily	Jul 29, 2020, 6:24... 82 days ago	402,534 Post Engag...	534,180	734,126	$0.005 Per Post Eng...	$1,829.24
Cold Audiences - Lookalike Audiences All - To...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$30.00 Daily	Oct 12, 2020, 7:1... 7 days ago	369,113 Post Engag...	464,652	721,392	$0.005 Per Post Eng...	$1,829.26
Cold Audiences - Lookalike Audiences All - To...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$30.00 Daily	Oct 8, 2020, 10:0... 11 days ago	355,790 Post Engag...	526,108	756,300	$0.01 Per Post Eng...	$1,829.45
Cold Audiences - Lookalike Audiences All - To...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$30.00 Daily	Oct 7, 2020, 9:23 ... 12 days ago	326,944 Post Engag...	480,411	742,720	$0.01 Per Post Eng...	$1,829.16
Cold Audiences - Lookalike Audiences All - To...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$30.00 Daily	Oct 7, 2020, 9:23 ... 12 days ago	289,812 Post Engag...	281,867	515,102	$0.01 Per Post Eng...	$1,829.39
Cold Audiences - Lookalike Audiences All - To...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$30.00 Daily	Oct 12, 2020, 7:1... 7 days ago	284,315 Post Engag...	488,979	701,444	$0.01 Per Post Eng...	$1,829.32
Cold Audiences - Lookalike Audiences All - To...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$30.00 Daily	Oct 7, 2020, 9:23 ... 12 days ago	278,187 Post Engag...	452,764	769,937	$0.01 Per Post Eng...	$1,829.58
Cold Audiences - Lookalike Audiences All - To...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$30.00 Daily	Oct 7, 2020, 9:23 ... 12 days ago	209,782 Post Engag...	338,962	555,035	$0.01 Per Post Eng...	$1,829.33
Cold Audiences - Lookalike Audiences All - To...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$30.00 Daily	Oct 7, 2020, 9:23 ... 12 days ago	151,955 Post Engag...	223,433	434,247	$0.01 Per Post Eng...	$1,830.26
Results from 9 ad sets				—	2,668,432 Post Engage...	2,126,440 People	5,930,303 Total	$0.01 Per Post Enga...	$16,464.99 Total Spent

Here above is an example of a content cycle bin ad set view of 9 different ad sets, each contained within the same single campaign, all optimized for ad set budget optimization, $30/day per ad set, and each with a single unique piece of content per ad set totalling 9 different pieces of content targeting this cold audience.

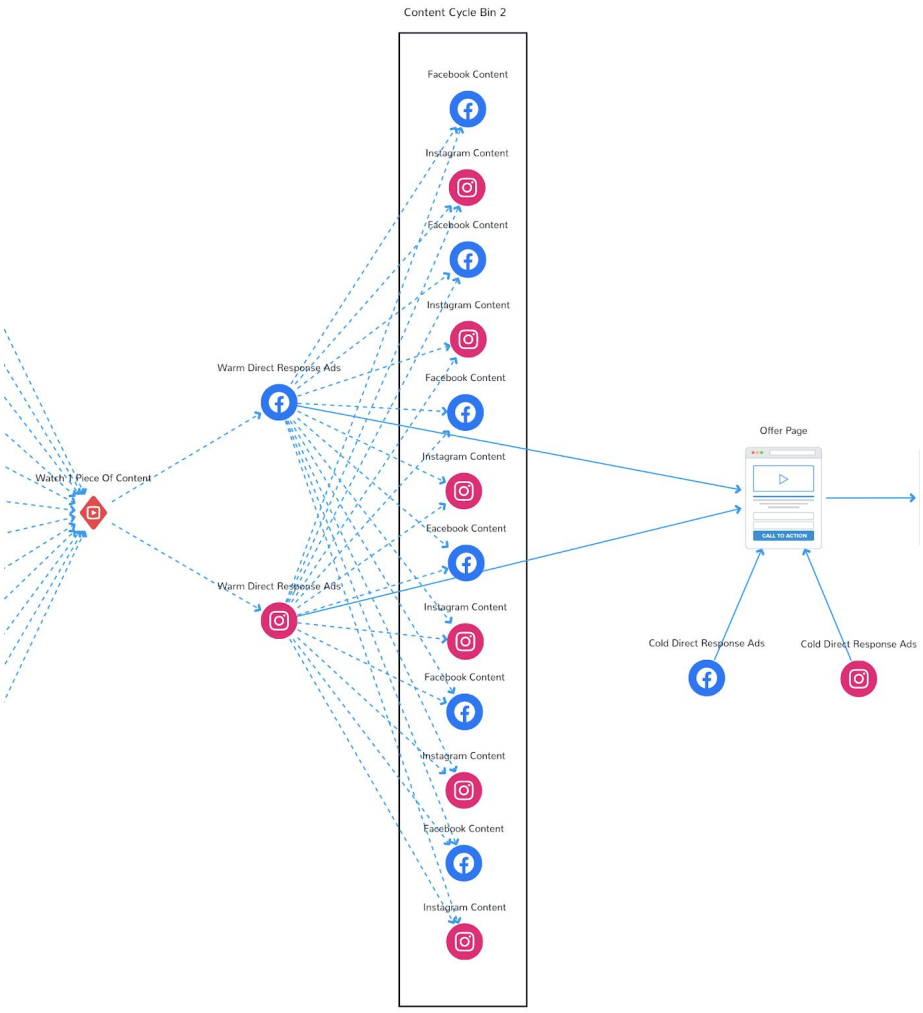
We want to trust FB algorithms and the 52,000 average data points FB tracks per user to allow FB to decide which person sees which piece of content. Rather than forcing our limited human viewpoints onto which video people will be probable to watch over the others.

You can see above the cost per engagement averaged out to $.01, and some pieces of content performed much better than the others in both cost and volume of getting people added into the warm audience.

It is important to note that for the Content Cycle Bin to work effectively, you need to be targeting the same audience within each ad set, and all these ad sets should be consolidated into 1 campaign.

This is not a sequence of content, it's like a spider web. We want to allow multiple options for where people can get caught into becoming aware of your brand rather than forcing them to go through a specific set of videos in order before seeing the direct response creatives.

This next step is where we are going to target the newly created warm audience with direct response, and at the same time with a second content cycle bin after watching 10 seconds of just 1 of the first videos in the content cycle bin 1.



Our goal here is to run standard response ads towards 'warm audiences.'

A warm audience in this case is people who watched 10 seconds of one of your content cycle bin 1 videos, or interacted with your social media profiles (both FB and IG).

Make sure when selecting all the audiences to select all of the options available, including visited social profile, engaged with post or ad, pressed ad button, messaged page or saved post. This is what will allow the capture of everyone who engaged on social and the 10 second video viewers

to be captured and targeted. Be sure to create for 365 day audience buckets, this widens the audience size which lowers costs.

You could keep the time window around 30 days if you want to limit the audience size which would allow you to spend less on technically more newly warm people, the downside is you miss out on people who have been warmed up and might be ready to buy outside of the 30 day window.

You're going to want to make sure you select the conversion objective for your direct response ads optimized for whatever standard event you're wanting as an outcome (purchase, lead, scheduled call, add to cart, etc).

You're going to create a second campaign as well optimized for engagement, and set up just like the 1st content cycle bin.

The campaign is going to be set up optimized for engagement, and will have 5-12 different ad sets within it optimized for ad set budget optimization.

Each ad set will contain the same cold audience targeting that you want to turn into customers.

Each ad set contains 1 of the 5-12 videos.

1 video per ad set.

I also typically duplicate this campaign after it's finished and will only change what's it's optimized for from engagement to video views optimized for thruplay.

Ad Set Name	Delivery	Bid Strategy	Budget	Last Significant Edit	Results	Reach	Impressions	Cost per Result	Amount Spent
Warm Audience - Social Interaction, Video Vie...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$5.00 Daily		70,096 Post Engag...	103,337	131,741	$0.004 Per Post Eng...	$304.94
Warm Audience - Social Interaction, Video Vie...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$5.00 Daily	Oct 7, 2020, 9:23 ... 12 days ago	63,365 Post Engag...	90,081	128,443	$0.005 Per Post Eng...	$304.97
Warm Audience - Social Interaction, Video Vie...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$5.00 Daily		59,192 Post Engag...	98,600	130,355	$0.01 Per Post Eng...	$305.03
Warm Audience - Social Interaction, Video Vie...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$5.00 Daily	Oct 8, 2020, 10:0... 11 days ago	48,436 Post Engag...	94,327	126,151	$0.01 Per Post Eng...	$304.97
Warm Audience - Social Interaction, Video Vie...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$5.00 Daily	Oct 7, 2020, 9:23 ... 12 days ago	48,136 Post Engag...	48,674	85,237	$0.01 Per Post Eng...	$304.95
Warm Audience - Social Interaction, Video Vie...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$5.00 Daily	Oct 8, 2020, 10:0... 11 days ago	47,230 Post Engag...	88,421	134,861	$0.01 Per Post Eng...	$305.10
Warm Audience - Social Interaction, Video Vie...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$5.00 Daily	Oct 8, 2020, 10:0... 11 days ago	45,513 Post Engag...	80,212	127,011	$0.01 Per Post Eng...	$305.07
Warm Audience - Social Interaction, Video Vie...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$5.00 Daily	Oct 8, 2020, 10:0... 11 days ago	37,561 Post Engag...	71,697	104,831	$0.01 Per Post Eng...	$305.16
Warm Audience - Social Interaction, Video Vie...	Active	Lowest cost Post Engage...	$5.00 Daily	Oct 7, 2020, 9:23 ... 12 days ago	26,307 Post Engag...	45,186	79,699	$0.01 Per Post Eng...	$305.24
Results from 9 ad sets				—	445,836 Post Engage...	390,678 People	1,048,329 Total	$0.01 Per Post Enga...	$2,745.43 Total Spent

Ideally you're spending the same amount on cost per ad set on cold vs warm, but sometimes clients try to control the process and that's why in this image above we had $30/day on cold and only $5/day on warm. If the costs are even per ad set, you get the highest probability of getting in front of the entire new warm audience for the same cost of $.01 per engagement to keep in front of them with both content from cycle bin 2 and the direct response ads.

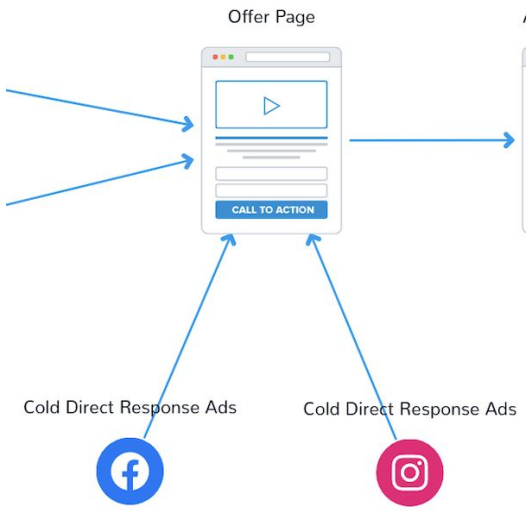
The targeting for these ad sets will be the same as your direct response ads, a warm audience.

The content should be different from the cold content selected.

The warm content used should really focus on supporting the sales cycle since these users are in the stage of the ad strategy where they are being pitched on a product, service or lead magnet in your direct response ads.

I always use content here that helps establish the right beliefs about the product and the brand, and the right biases as well. Content that gives credibility, authority and establishes social proof with the warm audience.

I'm also ensuring that we are going to handle future objections. Commonly there's one main set of objections that are the most common for why people won't buy from you. Turn those into pieces of content that will be targeted towards warm audiences at this stage as the advertising process so when they see a direct response ad that's targeting them at the same time, they become more probable to convert on it because you handled an objection that was holding them back from taking the action through content.



There is one very important element to this entire advertising strategy to ensure it's working.

And that's running standard cold direct response ads towards wherever you're sending traffic to.

This allows you to see the difference in costs, and volume of response between the warmed up audience being targeted with direct response ads vs the ice cold audience being targeted with direct response ads at the same time.

We typically see direct response still perform well, we just see warmed up audiences perform that much

better in both more volume and lower costs for whatever the campaigns are optimized for.

Campaign Name	Delivery	Results	Reach	Frequency	Cost per Result	Budget	Amount Spent
Warm Audience - Complete Registration - Min...	Active	80 Completed ...	60,622	2.20	$14.09 Per Complet...	$100.00 Daily	$1,127.35
Cold Audience - Complete Registration - Mini ...	Active	37 Completed ...	49,024	2.01	$30.52 Per Complet...	$100.00 Daily	$1,129.30

Here's an example of the differences between the cold and warm targeting direct response ads.

The warm audience which has been seeing content from content cycle bin 2, and was brought into that audience in the first place through content cycle bin 1 is half the cost, and more than double the booked call volume on a funnel that has an opt in, then an application with mini webinar, then a call scheduler and closing with the confirmation of call page.

The buyer volume was also more than double the closing rate of cold audience because the audience was aware of the brand and was excited to get on the phone, vs cold was much more skeptical although people still bought profitably from that cold direct response audience too.

Remember, this strategy is best deployed when working with lower ad spend budget clients giving you a ton of room to scale up with.

Scale the content cycle bin 1 daily ad set budgets when ready to scale, as this is what fills the warm audiences being targeted in content cycle bin 2 and the direct response ads.

The content cycle bin 2 and direct response ads should only scale in spend when there's more audience volume created from scaling content cycle bin 1 first.

This keeps costs extremely low for building audiences to hit with direct response and you should see a significant reduction in costs per whatever you're optimizing your direct response campaigns for (purchase, lead, add to cart, scheduled call, etc).

The goal is not to frame them on much in the first set of videos, more to get them into the warm audience at extremely low costs to lower the overall cost to acquire customers. A lot of the framing is done in the second content cycle bin which averages a frequency of 3-5 pieces of content in a month depending on spend levels.

Below are some examples for you from some personal brands we've worked with for what videos we've used for Content Cycle Bin 1 vs Content Cycle Bin 2.

Content Cycle Bin 1 Examples:

- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=642729793091130
- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=449757672617236
- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=341642520557347
- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=282487529706970
- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=306900940491071
- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=2623398541234830
- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=238607450516140
- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=144410693555548
- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=2920759251326962

Content Cycle Bin 2 Examples:

- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=2855087621401084
- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=449757672617236
- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=341642520557347
- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=573959639950396
- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=2571220963140508
- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=3640636049283127
- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=609135433344839
- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=608512056747748
- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=285610872456501

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